

Durability as defensible evidence

What it would take for an accreditation panel to treat a curriculum-durability signal as **evidence**, not vendor opinion — a defined instrument, an honest claim, and a pre-registered measurement programme that validates the score against graduate outcomes.

Worked against Master of Information Systems (18/36, HIGH RISK).

1 · THE INSTRUMENT

A frozen, transparent rubric

Ten durability dimensions plus an Irreplaceability premium, each scored **0–3** against published descriptors, to a **/36** total on a four-band scale. The schema is version-pinned and timestamped.

D1 Automation D2 Systems D3 Technical D4 Decisions

D5 AI Literacy D6 Domain D7 Research D8 Human

D9 Currency D10 Outcomes ↗ Irreplaceability

Critical 0–11

High 12–19

Moderate 20–27

Resilient 28–36

2 · THE EVIDENCE BASE (STATED HONESTLY)

The mechanism is evidenced; the instrument is the open question

~~"No causal evidence links labour-market-informed curriculum revision to graduate outcomes."~~

Demand-aligned curriculum revision is now causally evidenced to raise wages (Salomons et al. 2025 — difference-in-differences over 365 German VET updates, ~+3.3% entry wages). **What no study yet validates is that a scored durability instrument predicts QILT outcomes for Australian university programs** — the evidence COMPASS can be first to produce.

3 · THE MEASUREMENT PROTOCOL — PROSPECT-DID (ONE STAGED STUDY, ONE PRE-REGISTRATION)

0 Pre-register & freeze · months 0–3 · ~free

Lodge a public pre-registration (OSF/AEA) declaring the rubric, the matching protocol (6-digit ASCED field + level + intake), the estimand (ATT, Callaway–Sant'Anna), the primary outcome (GOS full-time employment), and the inference plan. **Cryptographically freeze and timestamp baseline scores** — this defeats score→outcome leakage and is itself the artefact a panel rewards, available before any outcome lands.

1 Back-test predictive validity · months 3–9 · first publishable signal <1 yr

Under one HREC secondary-use approval, join frozen scores to the institution's **own existing GOS/GOS-L unit records** at 6-digit ASCED; pool 3–5 cohorts; report calibration, discrimination (AUC) and incremental ΔAUC over a confounder-only baseline. Positive = the score validates; near-zero = a clean, publishable null. Either way is the highest-value result.

2 Embedded difference-in-differences · years 2–7 · confirmatory

Let a staggered-adoption DiD mature as COMPASS-redesigned cohorts reach GOS then GOS-L, reporting event-study pre-trends as they accrue. Upgrade to PLIDA/BLADE ATO-linked verified earnings only once Step 1 shows signal worth scaling.

4 · WHY A PANEL CAN RELY ON IT

✓ **Pre-registered** — hypotheses & analysis fixed before outcomes are seen.

✓ **Standard estimator** — Callaway–Sant'Anna DiD, not cross-sectional correlation.

✓ **Frozen baseline** — timestamped scores defeat hindsight fitting.

✓ **Stays in-institution** — unit-record joins run inside the university; nothing exported.

5 · ILLUSTRATIVE STANDARDS MAPPING

STANDARD	WHAT COMPASS EVIDENCE PROVIDES
AACSB 2020 · Std 4 Curriculum	A documented, labour-market-referenced basis for currency and relevance of program content.
TEQSA HESF · 3.1 Course Design	Outcomes reflect current and emerging employment skills, with an external reference point.
TEQSA HESF · 5.3 Monitoring & Review	A repeatable, external benchmark for the periodic review-and-improvement cycle.